

Now let's look at a tougher case.

My Division. My body is fatally injured, as are the brains of my two brothers. My brain is divided, and each half is successfully transplanted into the body of one of my brothers. Each of the resulting people believes that he is me, seems to remember living my life, has my character, and is in every other way psychologically continuous with me. And he has a body that is very like mine.

Let's call the resulting people *Lefty* and *Righty*. Then we seem to have four options:

- (1) You survive as A.
- (2) You survive as B.
- (3) You survive as both A and B.
- (4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)–(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with
option (4): you do not survive.

But this looks bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the right kinds of connections to both A and B.

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemisphere Transplant but not My
Division.

Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is required for your survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

But here is an odd consequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant operation. Next to you on another hospital bed is a body into whom the other hemisphere was transplanted.

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

You think that you know that you are the person you remember being. But, if that other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you remember being.



Here's a quite different way of responding to My Division. Recall this option:

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false, because the psychological connections to Marsy and Venusy are branching connections.

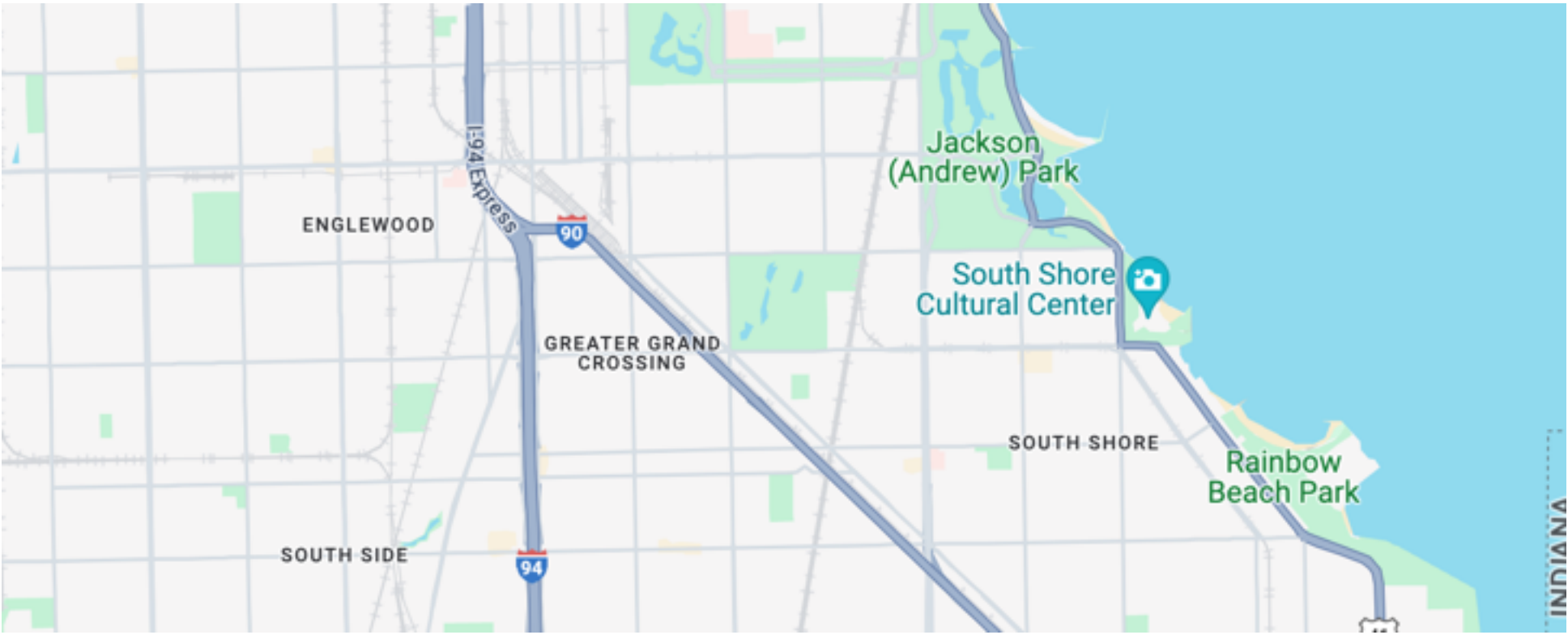
You survive as
Lefty and Righty.

We rejected this on the grounds that Lefty is not identical to Righty, so that you cannot be identical to both. But this neglects a possibility: maybe you were already

Lefty and Righty. You thought that you were one person; but in fact you were already two.

This is a strange and surprising view. Here is one way to get your mind around it.

Consider a case in which two roads 'overlap' in space.



ENGLEWOOD

Jackson
(Andrew) Park

South Shore
Cultural Center

GREATER GRAND
CROSSING

SOUTH SHORE

Rainbow
Beach Park

SOUTH SIDE

INDIANA

One can describe this situation in a way which makes it seem mysterious. I-90 and I-94 are separate highways; the stretch of highway north of 65th street is one highway; and yet it is identical to both I-90 and I-94. How can this be???

The puzzle here is only superficial. Roads are things which have different spatial parts located in different places. Two roads can occupy the same space just by sharing some of the same parts. No big deal.

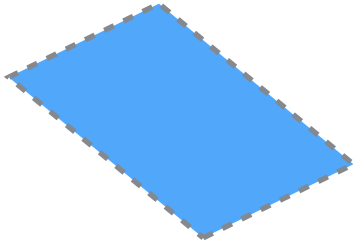
On one view, people -- and other objects -- have a relation to time which is similar to the relation in which roads stand to space. Like roads, we seem to have spatial parts. But on this view, we also have **temporal parts**. Just as I exist in separate locations by having separate spatial parts in those distinct locations, so I exist at different times by having different temporal parts in those different times.



There are also (as the contemporary philosopher Mark Johnston points out) practical problems.

Suppose that these are all of your temporal parts.
(In fact, there would be vastly more.) On the four-
dimensionalist view, you are identical to this large
collection of temporal parts.

This seems absurd. But if it really is absurd, that looks like a possible problem for the four-dimensionalist view which gives rise to the existence of personites in the first place.



But that time period is the whole of your personite's existence! Your personite has feelings, hopes, and dreams (just like you); how can it be just for you to decide to give that personite a 'life' with all intense study and no fun?

Let's call the resulting people Lefty and Righty. Then we see to have four

options:

(3) You survive as both A and B.

(4) You do not survive.

(1) You survive as A.

(2) You survive as B.

option(4): you do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)-(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with

But this book bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the

right kinds of connections to both A and B.

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemispher Transplant but not My

Diviſion.

Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is

required for you survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

But here is another sequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant. Next to you on

another hospital bed is already in the room where was transplanted.

remember being.

You think that you know what you are thinking. But, if that

other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you

But how could you ~~un~~identity ~~what~~ you are ~~dependent~~ on ~~what~~ happens with that

otherbody?

survival by adding on a non-branching clause. Intuitively, the idea is that whether

This is an argument against the idea that we can save the psychological theory of

you are the same person as ~~X~~ depends only on relations between you and ~~X~~ — it

can't possibly depend on relations to something!

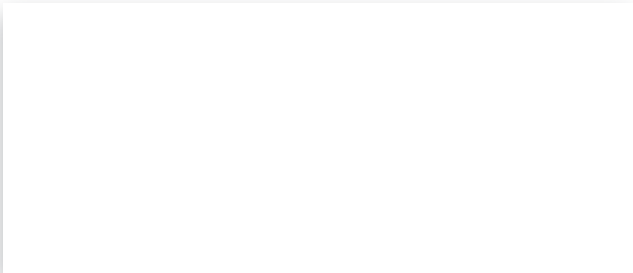
We can turn this into an argument against the psychological theory:

because the psychological connections to Mars and Venus are branching

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the

connections.

Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false,



Lefty and Righty.



Yours truly,
Sincerely,
Yours truly,
Sincerely,

Rejected this on the grounds that Lefty is not identical to Righty, so that you

cannot be identical to both. But this neglects a possibility: maybe you're already

Lefty and Righty. Youth that you were on; but in fact you were

all ready two.

Consider a case in which two roads 'overlap' in space.



This is a strange and surprising view. Here is one way to get your mind around it.

One can describe this situation in a way which makes it seem mysterious. 1-90 and

94 are separate highways; the stretch of highway north of 65th street is one

highway; and yet it is identical to both I-90 and I-94. How can this be???

parts located in different places. Two roads can occupy the same space just by

The puzzle here is only superficial. Roads are things which have different spatial

sharing some of the same parts. No big deal.

On one view, people – and other objects – have a relation to time which is similar

to the relation in which roads stand to space. Like roads, we seem to have spatial

parts. But not this view, we also have temporal parts. Just as I exist in separate

positions by having separate parts in these distinct locations, so that

different times by having different temperatures in the different times.

There are also (as the contemporary philosopher Mark Johnston

prints out) practical problems.

(In fact, there would be vastly more.) On the four-

Suppose that these are all of your moral parts.

collection of temporal parts.

dimensionalist view, you are identical to this large

This seems absurd. But if it really is absurd, that

dimensionalist view which gives rise to the

existence of persons in the first place.

looks like a possible problem for the four-



whole of your personite's

But that time period is the

existence! Your personite

dreams (just like you); how

a 'life' with all intense study

decide to give that person it

can it be just for you to

has feelings, hopes, and

and no fun?



(2) Whether I am the same person as X depends only on

(C) The psychological theory of survival is false.

survival is true, it must be a 'non-branching' theory.

relationship between x and y .



(1) If some version of the psychological theory of

(3) No 'non-branching' theory can be true. (2)



We've seen that My Division can be used to make trouble for materialist and

psychological theories of survival.